

Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

### SWIRLING SYMPHONY OF LIGHTS

■ Artists perform during Noor: Festival of Lights, one of the biggest Diwali celebrations in Dubai, at Souk Al Seef. Diwali fever has swept across the UAE and around the world, with shoppers making last-minute purchases of lamps, sweets and festive hampers ahead of the festival today. Celebrated by millions worldwide, Diwali marks new beginnings, prosperity, and the victory of good over evil.

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## Pakistan and Afghanistan agree to truce after weeks of deadly clashes

Ceasefire follows high-level talks mediated by Turkey in Doha on Saturday

**DUBAI**  
BY ASHFAQ AHMED  
Managing Editor

Pakistan and Afghanistan yesterday agreed to an immediate ceasefire at talks in Doha, after fighting this month killed dozens of people and injured hundreds.

The talks, hosted by Qatar and mediated by Turkey, lasted nearly 13 hours on Saturday, culminating in the signing of a ceasefire agreement

early yesterday. Pakistan's Defence Minister Khawaja Asif confirmed on X: "The terrorist attacks from Afghanistan on Pakistan's soil will cease immediately. Both neighbouring countries will respect each other's territory."

Pakistan publicly thanked the mediators, with Asif stating, "We are sincerely grateful to both brotherly countries, Qatar and Turkey."

#### Positive response

The Taliban government's chief spokesman, Zabihullah Mujahid, gave a positive response to the outcome of the talks. He said both countries had signed a bilateral agreement.

"It has been decided that neither country will undertake any hostile actions against the other, nor will they support groups carrying out attacks against Pakistan. Both sides will refrain from targeting each other's security forces, civilians or critical infrastructure."

A mechanism would be established in the future, "under the mediation of intermediary countries," to review bilateral claims and ensure the effective implementation of this agreement. A follow-up meeting is scheduled for October 25 in Istanbul to finalise implementation details.

— With inputs from agencies  
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## Dubai bans delivery bikes from left lanes

MOVE TO IMPROVE ROAD SAFETY AND DELIVERY SECTOR COMPLIANCE

**DUBAI**  
BY ASHFAQ AHMED  
Managing Editor

Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) and Dubai Police are set to implement new rules restricting delivery bikes from using high-speed lanes on major roads, starting November 1.

The move aims to curb accidents, improve traffic discipline, and enhance the safety of both riders and other road users.

Under the rules, delivery riders will be prohibited from using the two leftmost lanes on roads with five lanes or more, and the leftmost lane on roads with three or four lanes. Roads with two lanes or fewer will have no restrictions for delivery bikes. Hussain Al Banna, CEO of Traffic and Roads Agency at RTA, said the decision follows extensive coordination with public and private sector partners to ensure rider safety.

#### Delivery sector's key role

"The delivery sector plays a key role in driving economic development and contributes effectively to enhancing service standards and achieving health, safety, and sustainability benchmarks. This decision aligns with the objectives of Dubai's Economic Agenda (D33) to double the size of the emirate's economy in the years ahead, while continuously updating laws and regulations to enhance both the delivery experience and road safety — two of RTA's top priorities," he said.

Al Banna added: "Prohibitory signs will be installed on directional signboards to indicate

**78,386**

delivery bike riders' violations over the past nine months

lanes restricted to commercial motorcycles, alongside existing signage that prohibits heavy vehicles and trucks from using high-speed lanes."

Major General Saif Muhair Al Mazrouei, Assistant Commander-in-Chief for Operations Affairs at Dubai Police, praised the strategic partnership between Dubai Police and RTA, which has strengthened coordination and joint efforts toward achieving the objectives of the Dubai Traffic Safety Strategy by reducing road fatalities.

He said: "Riders who violate the rules will be fined Dh500 for the first offence and Dh700 for the second, with permits suspended upon a third violation. Those exceeding 100km/h on roads with speed limits of 100km/h or above will be fined Dh200 for the first offence, Dh300 for the second, and Dh400 for the third."

Maj Gen Al Mazrouei added: "Police data recorded 854 traffic accidents last year and 962 accidents in 2025, resulting from violations by delivery riders. Dubai Police also issued 70,166 violations last year against delivery motorcycle riders for failing to comply with traffic laws. The number has risen to 78,386 violations over the past nine months of this year, reflecting the persistence of unsafe riding behaviours among some drivers."



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# Happy Diwali

Wishing you a sparkling Dhanteras & a radiant Diwali!  
May your days be filled with light, laughter, & new adventures.

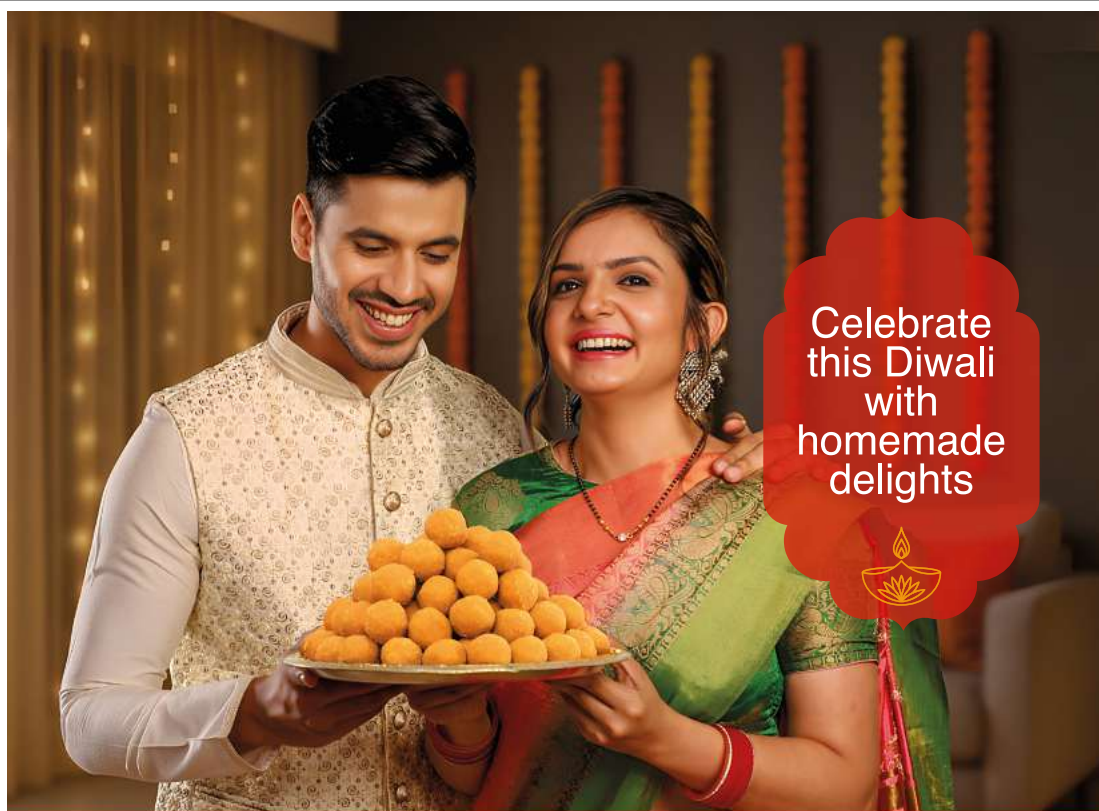


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